KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4–5 · UNIT 6: VOICES OF CHANGE · WEEK 29 · READING

Rolling Toward a Decision — Teacher Lesson Plan & Answer Key

Learning objectives: Students identify the parts of a persuasive letter (claim, reasons with evidence, counterargument, rebuttal, closing and call to action, transitions), recognize three reasoning traps (bandwagon, overgeneralization and attacking the person), check speakers' evidence against a fact sheet, judge the reasoning on both sides of a debate fairly, propose a compromise, and write the opening, rebuttal and closing of their own persuasive letter.

Duration: 35–45 minutes
Materials: Computer or tablet with the lesson open · pencil · printed Pre & Post sheet

Lesson flow (as it appears on screen)

1. Slide 0 — Intro and name capture: Flagstaff, Arizona, sits about 7,000 feet up in the largest continuous ponderosa pine forest in North America and in 2001 became the world's first International Dark Sky City. In a made-up story, the City Council is deciding where to build a new skate park, and neighbors on both sides speak at a public meeting. The student types first and last name so results go to KingCretot Experience. Read the scoring rules together: 2 tries per question, Pathway Points only for a correct first try, and the answer plus the reason appear after the 2nd miss. Typed one-word answers ignore capital letters and are accepted when the answer contains an accepted word.
2. Slide 1 — Warm-Up: Week 28 Review (8 pts, 4 each): relevant notes, citations, synthesis and paraphrasing.
3. Slide 2 — Pencil Break (Pre): the student opens or prints the Pre/Post sheet (grade4-5/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G4-5W29.pdf) and completes Page 1 (Pre-Lesson Warm-Up) on paper before any teaching.
4. Slide 3 — Picture It: Inside a Persuasive Letter. Claim, reason and evidence, counterargument, rebuttal, and a closing with a call to action, joined by transitions, modeled with "A Bike Rack for the Library." Three reasoning traps: bandwagon, overgeneralization (always, never, everyone) and attacking the person.
5. Slide 4 — Vocabulary Round-Up: 8 flip cards (counterargument, rebuttal, transition, bandwagon, overgeneralization, compromise, shielded, hazard).
6. Slide 5 — Your Turn: Using the Words (8 pts, 4 each): one multiple-choice and one typed vocabulary item.
7. Slide 6 — Speaker 1: Nizhoni, for Site 1 (5 pts). A made-up public comment in five paragraphs: an eleven-year-old asks for the east-side field. She and her brother Niko counted 14 skaters weaving between cars in a grocery store parking lot; she cites the survey (248 of 400 support a skate park); she answers the noise-and-lights worry (open 7 in the morning until sunset, no lights); and she ends with a bandwagon line.
8. Slide 7 — Speaker 2: Mr. Nolan, for Site 2 (5 pts). He lives across from the east-side field and supports a skate park, but at Site 2 by the sports fields: homes 500 feet away instead of 150, and kids walking to Site 1 would cross a busy road with no crosswalk. He admits Site 2 has no bus stop yet and suggests adding one, then ends with an overgeneralization ("skaters never clean up").

9. Slide 8 — Check the Evidence: The City Fact Sheet (10 pts, 5 each): a made-up table (nearest homes, bus stop, crosswalk, 1.5 miles from the east side), a $600,000 cost with a state grant that could pay up to half, hours from 7 in the morning until sunset with no lights, and a survey (248 support, 132 oppose, 20 unsure) that did not ask which site people prefer.
10. Slide 9 — Teach: Judging an Argument, Fairly. Four tests (relevant, enough, reliable, fair reasoning) and a chart of each speaker's strong points and weak spots. Both want a skate park and disagree only about where, so judge the reasoning, not the side, and look for a compromise.
11. Slide 10 — Argument Detective (12 pts, 6 each): name the reasoning trap, test the survey evidence, strengthen a reason, and judge both sides fairly.
12. Slide 11 — Fix the Sentence, Part 1 (8 pts, 4 each): each sentence comes from Nisha's letter to the City Council, and each item names the one kind of fix. The whole sentence is checked exactly (straight or curly quotes and extra spaces are OK). The corrected sentence appears after the 2nd miss.
13. Slide 12 — Fix the Sentence, Part 2 (8 pts, 4 each): two more sentences, same rules (could have, a double negative, affect or effect, good or well, a run-on, and subject-verb agreement).
14. Slide 13 — Back It Up With Evidence (4 pts): quote the speaker or fact sheet sentence named in the item, starting with the tag shown (such as Nizhoni says), a comma, and the exact words in quotation marks with the end mark inside. Checked exactly.
15. Slide 14 — Writer's Turn: Your Letter to the City Council (6 pts): one typed part of a persuasive letter (an opening, a counterargument and rebuttal, or a closing) for EITHER site auto-checked by rules: a minimum word count; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the speeches or the fact sheet (allowed names count as one word); and every key idea included. Feedback names the rule that was missed, and a model answer appears after the 2nd miss. Encourage covering the original before writing.
16. Slide 15 — Match-Up Round (10 pts): argument parts, reasoning traps and terms, or transitions matched to their jobs (a different set each attempt), 2 pts each on the first try.
17. Slide 16 — Speed Trail (bonus XP only): 3 quick argument questions against the student's own best time.
18. Slide 17 — Boss Challenge (16 pts, 8 each): two-step items (judge the evidence on both sides, choose a compromise, pick the counterargument and the strongest rebuttal, or revise a closing without a trap).
19. Slide 18 — Pencil Break (Post): the student completes Page 2 (Post-Lesson Activity) of the same sheet (grade4-5/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G4-5W29.pdf), including the ★ Challenge writing task if time allows, before seeing the score.
20. Slide 19 — Results (Case Made!): the score out of 100 is sent to KingCretot Experience. 85 or higher shows "Persuasion Pro!" with the congratulations message "Persuasion pro! You judged both sides fairly!" and a big confetti burst; below 85 shows "Keep Going!" with encouragement ("You're getting closer, and every try makes you stronger."), and the next attempt brings a fresh question set (sets rotate 1, 2, 3). Both messages remind the student to finish the Post-Lesson Challenge sheet.

Lesson answer key with reasoning

Every scored item the student sees, in order, across all three rotating question sets. Each item allows 2 tries and earns Pathway Points only on a correct first try. The "why" is the same reasoning shown on screen after a second missed try.

WARM-UP: WEEK 28 REVIEW (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
rv1_s0	Set 1: Nikhil's research question is "Why do bats hang upside down?" Which note is NOT relevant? [Bats appear in many Halloween decorations. / Hanging lets bats drop into flight quickly. / Bats' leg tendons let them hang without using energy. / Hanging high keeps bats away from many predators.]	**Bats appear in many Halloween decorations.**	A relevant note helps answer the research question. Halloween decorations have nothing to do with why bats hang upside down (Week 28).
rv2_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: Nisha writes "(Source B)" after a fact to show where she found it. A note like this that names a source is called a ___.	**citation** (also accepted with "a" or "an" or in the plural)	Naming your source is citing it, and the note itself is a citation (Week 28).
rv1_s1	Set 2: Which sentence SYNTHESIZES two of last week's sources correctly? [Monarchs born in late summer save their energy for the trip (Source B), and they spend the winter in cool fir forests in central Mexico (Source A). / Monarchs spend the winter in cool fir forests (Source A). / Monarchs born in late summer save their energy for the trip (Source C). / These forests give them a cool, steady climate for the winter.]	**Monarchs born in late summer save their energy for the trip (Source B), and they spend the winter in cool fir forests in central Mexico (Source A).**	Synthesis combines facts from two or more sources, each cited correctly. The other choices use one source, cite the wrong source, or copy without quotation marks (Week 28).
rv2_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: retelling ONE source's idea in your own words is called ___.	**paraphrasing** (also accepted: paraphrase, paraphrased)	Paraphrasing retells one source in your own words; synthesizing combines several sources (Week 28).
rv1_s2	Set 3: Noelle finds one reliable source saying a tree is "about 90 feet tall" and another saying it is "nearly 100 feet tall." What should she write? [The tree is about 90 to 100 feet tall, and she cites both sources. / The tree is exactly 95 feet tall, which scientists have proven. / Nothing, because the sources disagree. / The tree is 100 feet tall, and she cites neither source.]	**The tree is about 90 to 100 feet tall, and she cites both sources.**	When reliable sources differ a little, report a range and cite both, just as the lesson did with the monarchs' lifespan (Week 28).
rv2_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: combining facts from two or more sources into one new statement, with each source named, is called ___.	**synthesizing** (also accepted: synthesize, synthesis)	Synthesizing joins ideas from several sources into a new statement (Week 28).

YOUR TURN: USING THE WORDS (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
v1_s0	Set 1: From the fact sheet: "If lights are ever added, city rules would require shielded lights that point down toward the ground." Flagstaff protects its dark night skies. What does shielded most likely mean here? [Covered so the light is blocked from shining up into the sky / Extra bright and colorful / Flashing on and off / Powered by the sun]	**Covered so the light is blocked from shining up into the sky**	Lights that "point down toward the ground" in a Dark Sky City are covered so their light does not spread upward. That is what shielded means here.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
v2_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: the other side's point, which a strong writer states fairly before answering it, is called the ___.	**counterargument** (also accepted: counter argument, counter-argument, counterclaim; with "a" or "an" or in the plural)	The other side's point is the counterargument (also called a counterclaim). The writer's answer to it is the rebuttal.
v1_s1	Set 2: From Mr. Nolan's speech: kids walking to Site 1 "would have to cross a busy road with no crosswalk. That is a hazard for younger children." What is a hazard? [A danger / A shortcut / A sidewalk / A rule]	**A danger**	Crossing a busy road without a crosswalk could hurt a child, so a hazard is a danger.
v2_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: a word or phrase like "however" or "as a result" that shows how ideas connect is called a ___.	**transition** (also accepted: transition word; with "a" or "an" or in the plural)	Transitions guide the reader: "however" shows a contrast, and "as a result" shows an effect.
v1_s2	Set 3: Which explanation of the difference between a BANDWAGON argument and real evidence is correct? [Bandwagon says to agree because many people do; real evidence gives facts that prove the reason is true. / They are the same thing. / Bandwagon arguments always use numbers, so they are evidence. / Real evidence means using words like "everyone" and "never."]	**Bandwagon says to agree because many people do; real evidence gives facts that prove the reason is true.**	Popularity alone is not proof. Evidence is facts, numbers, or examples that support a reason.
v2_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: when each side gives up part of what it wants so that both can agree, they reach a ___.	**compromise** (also accepted with "a" or "an" or in the plural)	A compromise means each side gives a little. The City Council might look for one between the two sites.

SPEAKER 1: NIZHONI, FOR SITE 1 (5 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
sa_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: in paragraph 2, Nizhoni says the skaters she counted were weaving between cars in a grocery store ___. Type the two-word answer.	**parking lot** (also accepted: lot; with "a" or "an" or in the plural)	Paragraph 2: "we counted 14 skaters in the grocery store parking lot on our street, weaving between cars."
sa_s1	Set 2: In paragraph 4, Nizhoni says, "Some neighbors worry about noise and lights. That is a fair concern." What job do these sentences do? [They state the counterargument fairly, before her rebuttal. / They state her main claim. / They give evidence that the park would be loud. / They are a bandwagon trap.]	**They state the counterargument fairly, before her rebuttal.**	She names the other side's worry and calls it fair. Then "However" begins her rebuttal: the park would close at sunset with no lights.
sa_s2	Set 3: Which sentence from Text A is Nizhoni's CLAIM? [I am here to ask you to build the new skate park at the east-side field, Site 1. / First, kids need a safe place to skate. / Second, skating is good exercise. / Thank you for listening.]	**I am here to ask you to build the new skate park at the east-side field, Site 1.**	The claim is the main thing she wants the council to do. "Kids need a safe place to skate" and "skating is good exercise" are reasons that support it.

SPEAKER 2: MR. NOLAN, FOR SITE 2 (5 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
sb_s0	Set 1: What is Mr. Nolan's CLAIM? [The city should build the skate park at Site 2, beside the sports fields, instead of Site 1. / The city should not build any skate park at all. / The city should build two skate parks. / Skaters should practice in parking lots.]	**The city should build the skate park at Site 2, beside the sports fields, instead of Site 1.**	Paragraph 1: "I support giving kids a place to skate. I am asking you to build it at Site 2." He disagrees about WHERE, not WHETHER.
sb_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: in paragraph 3, Mr. Nolan says kids walking to Site 1 would have to cross a busy road with no ___.	**crosswalk** (also accepted: cross walk; with "a" or "an" or in the plural)	Paragraph 3: "Kids walking to Site 1 would have to cross a busy road with no crosswalk."
sb_s2	Set 3: In paragraph 4, Mr. Nolan admits, "They have a point; Site 2 has no bus stop yet." Why does this make his argument STRONGER, not weaker? [It shows he treats the other side fairly before giving his rebuttal, which helps listeners trust him. / It proves Site 1 is the better choice. / It is his main claim. / It is a bandwagon argument.]	**It shows he treats the other side fairly before giving his rebuttal, which helps listeners trust him.**	Admitting a fair point and then answering it ("the city could add a bus stop there") is a counterargument with a rebuttal. It makes a speaker sound fair, not weak.

CHECK THE EVIDENCE: THE CITY FACT SHEET (5 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
qp1_s0	Set 1: Two-step: in the survey, 248 people support building a skate park and 132 oppose it. How many MORE people support it than oppose it? [116 / 106 / 126 / 380]	**116**	248 − 132 = 116. (380 is what you get if you add instead of subtract.)
qp2_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: two steps. Read the survey line carefully. The survey did NOT ask people which ___ they prefer. Type one word.	**site** (also accepted: location; with "a" or "an" or in the plural)	The fact sheet says, "The survey did not ask which site people prefer." That matters when a speaker uses the survey to support one site.
qp1_s1	Set 2: Two-step: the nearest homes are 500 feet from Site 2 and 150 feet from Site 1. How many feet FARTHER from homes is Site 2? [350 feet / 650 feet / 250 feet / 450 feet]	**350 feet**	500 − 150 = 350 feet. (650 is the sum, not the difference.)
qp2_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: under the plan, the skate park would close every day at ___. Type one word.	**sunset**	The fact sheet says the planned hours are "7 in the morning until sunset, with no lights."
qp1_s2	Set 3: Two-step: the park would cost $600,000, and a state grant could pay up to half, if approved. If the grant pays half, how much would the city still pay? [$300,000 / $600,000 / $150,000 / $1,200,000]	**$300,000**	Half of $600,000 is $300,000, so the city would pay the other $300,000.
qp2_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: two steps. Mr. Nolan says Site 2 has no bus stop. Check the table: which thing does SITE 1 have none of yet? Type one word.	**crosswalk** (also accepted with "a" or "an" or in the plural)	The table shows Site 1 has a bus stop but no crosswalk on the busy road yet, while Site 2 has sidewalks but no bus stop yet. Each site has a weak spot.

ARGUMENT DETECTIVE (6 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
d1_s0	Set 1: Nizhoni ends, "Honestly, everybody I know wants this park, so you should vote yes." Which reasoning trap is this? [Bandwagon: it says to agree because many people do, not because of evidence. / Attacking the person: it insults the neighbors. / A fair counterargument and rebuttal. / Strong survey evidence.]	**Bandwagon: it says to agree because many people do, not because of evidence.**	"Everybody I know wants it" is about popularity, not proof. Her earlier reasons about safety and exercise are much stronger than this ending.
d2_s0	Set 1: Mr. Nolan says, "Skaters never clean up after themselves." Which explanation of the problem is correct? [It is an overgeneralization: "never" claims something about every skater, with no evidence. / It is strong evidence from the fact sheet. / It is a fair counterargument. / It is a bandwagon trap.]	**It is an overgeneralization: "never" claims something about every skater, with no evidence.**	The word "never" covers all skaters, and he gives no facts. His points about distance and the crosswalk are much stronger than this one.
d1_s1	Set 2: Nizhoni uses the survey (248 of 400 support a skate park) to support SITE 1. Which explanation of the weakness is correct? [The survey asked about building a skate park, not which site, so it supports Mr. Nolan's plan just as much. / The numbers are added wrong. / Surveys can never be used as evidence. / There is no weakness; the survey proves Site 1 is best.]	**The survey asked about building a skate park, not which site, so it supports Mr. Nolan's plan just as much.**	The fact sheet says, "The survey did not ask which site people prefer." Mr. Nolan also supports a skate park, so the survey does not help choose a site.
d2_s1	Set 2: Which addition would make Nizhoni's parking-lot evidence STRONGER? [Counting skaters in the lot on several different days and times, not just one Saturday / Saying the skaters are her best friends / Adding that everyone at her school agrees with her / Saying the parking lot is ugly]	**Counting skaters in the lot on several different days and times, not just one Saturday**	One count is a small sample. Counting on several days shows whether the problem happens often. The other choices add no evidence, and one is a bandwagon trap.
d1_s2	Set 3: Mr. Nolan says, "many of us on my street work night shifts and sleep during the day." What would make this reason STRONGER? [Evidence, such as a letter signed by neighbors who sleep during the day / Saying it louder / Adding that skaters are always noisy / Saying that everyone agrees with him]	**Evidence, such as a letter signed by neighbors who sleep during the day**	A claim about "many of us" needs facts. A signed letter would show how many neighbors are affected. The other choices are traps or add nothing.
d2_s2	Set 3: Find the mistake! Nikhil says, "Mr. Nolan is against skate parks." Which explanation is correct? [Mr. Nolan supports a skate park; he disagrees only about the site and asks for Site 2. / Nikhil is right; Mr. Nolan wants no skate park. / Mr. Nolan wants the park at Site 1. / Mr. Nolan did not speak at the meeting.]	**Mr. Nolan supports a skate park; he disagrees only about the site and asks for Site 2.**	Paragraph 1 of Text B: "I support giving kids a place to skate. I am asking you to build it at Site 2." Restating the other side accurately is part of arguing fairly.

FIX THE SENTENCE (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
fs1_s0	Set 1: Letter greeting: add the punctuation mark that ends the greeting. Dear Council Members	**Dear Council Members,** (also accepted: Dear Council Members:)	A letter greeting ends with a comma. In a formal business letter, a colon is also correct.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
fs2_s0	Set 1: Transition: add the comma after the transition word. However the park would close at sunset.	**However, the park would close at sunset.**	Put a comma after a transition word like “However” at the start of a sentence.
fs3_s0	Set 1: Grammar: fix the “could of” mistake. The council could of voted last month.	**The council could have voted last month.**	“Could of” is a mistake for “could have,” which sounds similar when spoken quickly.
fs4_s0	Set 1: Double negative: change ONE word to fix it. There isn't no crosswalk on that road.	**There isn't any crosswalk on that road.** (also accepted: There isn't a crosswalk on that road.; There is no crosswalk on that road.)	“Isn’t” and “no” are two negatives. Change “no” to “any” (or “a”), or change “isn’t” to “is,” so the sentence says what you mean.
fs1_s1	Set 2: Capital letters: fix the three capital-letter mistakes. the city of flagstaff, arizona, is famous for its dark skies.	**The city of Flagstaff, Arizona, is famous for its dark skies.**	Capitalize the first word of a sentence and the names of a city and a state.
fs2_s1	Set 2: Letter closing: capitalize the first word and add the comma. yours truly	**Yours truly,**	In a letter closing, capitalize only the first word and end with a comma.
fs3_s1	Set 2: Affect or effect: fix the word. The noise could effect neighbors who sleep during the day.	**The noise could affect neighbors who sleep during the day.**	“Affect” is usually the verb (to change something). “Effect” is usually the noun (the result).
fs4_s1	Set 2: Good or well: fix the word. Nizhoni spoke very good at the meeting.	**Nizhoni spoke very well at the meeting.**	“Well” describes HOW she spoke (an adverb). “Good” describes a noun, as in “a good speech.”
fs1_s2	Set 3: Transition phrase: add the missing comma. On the other hand the sports fields already have sidewalks.	**On the other hand, the sports fields already have sidewalks.**	Put a comma after a transition phrase like “On the other hand.”
fs2_s2	Set 3: City and state: add BOTH commas. Skaters in Flagstaff Arizona need a safe place to skate.	**Skaters in Flagstaff, Arizona, need a safe place to skate.**	In a sentence, put a comma between the city and the state, and another comma after the state.
fs3_s2	Set 3: Run-on sentence: fix it by adding a period and a capital letter. The park closes at sunset it will have no lights.	**The park closes at sunset. It will have no lights.**	Two complete sentences ran together. End the first with a period and capitalize the first word of the second.
fs4_s2	Set 3: Grammar: fix the verb so it agrees with the subject. Each of the sites have a different problem.	**Each of the sites has a different problem.**	The subject is “Each” (singular), not “sites,” so the verb is “has.”

BACK IT UP WITH EVIDENCE (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
qt_s0	Set 1: This sentence connects Nizhoni’s evidence to her safety reason. Quote it. Original (Text A, paragraph 2): A skate park would get them out of traffic. Start with: Nizhoni says	**Nizhoni says, "A skate park would get them out of traffic."**	Put a comma after the tag, then copy every exact word inside quotation marks, with the period inside.
qt_s1	Set 2: This sentence gives Mr. Nolan’s safety concern about Site 1. Quote it. Original (Text B, paragraph 3): That is a hazard for younger children. Start with: Mr. Nolan says	**Mr. Nolan says, "That is a hazard for younger children."**	Put a comma after the tag, then copy every exact word inside quotation marks, with the period inside.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
qt_s2	Set 3: This sentence shows why the survey cannot settle WHICH site is better. Quote it. Original (Text C, survey line): The survey did not ask which site people prefer. Start with: The fact sheet states	**The fact sheet states, "The survey did not ask which site people prefer."**	Put a comma after the tag, then copy every exact word inside quotation marks, with the period inside.

WRITER'S TURN: YOUR LETTER TO THE CITY COUNCIL (6 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
wt_s0	Set 1: Write the opening of your letter: state a CLAIM for Site 1 OR Site 2, then give one reason, starting the reason with a transition such as first, one reason, or to begin. Ideas to choose from: Site 1 is in the neighborhood, near a bus stop, and gets skaters out of parking lots. Site 2 is farther from homes and already has sidewalks and parking. Use at least 16 words. Do not copy 4 or more words in a row from the speeches or the fact sheet. Name the site you choose: Site 1 or Site 2. State your claim with a word like should, urge, or please. Begin your reason with a transition such as first or one reason. Original: "First, kids need a safe place to skate. Last Saturday, my brother Niko and I counted 14 skaters in the grocery store parking lot on our street, weaving between cars. A skate park would get them out of traffic. Second, skating is good ..." (the full passage is on screen; it is long, so only its opening is shown here)	**Sample:** I urge the council to pick Site 2 for our skate park. First, its spot near the sports fields is far enough from houses that daytime sleepers will not be bothered.	A strong answer names a site, states a clear claim (should, urge, please), and gives one reason that begins with a transition, in new words. Either site can be argued well. Auto-check rubric: at least 16 words; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original (names count as one word); must include: site 1 or site 2 or east side or sports field; should or urge or ask or please or support or choose or build or favor or recommend; first or one reason or to begin or to start or because or since or for example.
wt_s1	Set 2: Write a counterargument and rebuttal: state the OTHER side's strongest point fairly, then answer it, using a transition such as however or on the other hand. Remember: Site 1 has no crosswalk yet and is close to homes. Site 2 has no bus stop yet and is 1.5 miles from the east side. Use at least 18 words. Do not copy 4 or more words in a row from the speeches or the fact sheet. State the other side fairly: begin with words like "Some neighbors worry" or "Supporters argue." Answer it with a transition such as however or on the other hand. Name the real issue: the crosswalk, the bus stop, the noise, or the distance. Original: "First, kids need a safe place to skate. Last Saturday, my brother Niko and I counted 14 skaters in the grocery store parking lot on our street, weaving between cars. A skate park would get them out of traffic. Second, skating is good ..." (the full passage is on screen; it is long, so only its opening is shown here)	**Sample:** Some neighbors worry that kids would have to dodge traffic on the way to Site 1; however, the city could paint a crosswalk at the corner before the park opens.	A strong answer fairly states the other side's point (with words like "Some neighbors worry"), answers it with a transition like however, and names the real issue (the crosswalk, bus stop, noise, or distance), in new words. Auto-check rubric: at least 18 words; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original (names count as one word); must include: some or others or people or neighbors or supporters or opponents or critics or argue or worry or say or believe or point; however or on the other hand or although or even though or but or yet or still; crosswalk or bus or noise or loud or home or house or far or mile or distance or traffic or road or sidewalk or sleep.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
wt_s2	Set 3: Write the closing of your letter: restate your claim politely, give a short reason, and ask the City Council to act. Avoid every reasoning trap. Avoid: bandwagon (“everybody wants it”), overgeneralization (“skaters never…”), and attacking the person. Use at least 16 words. Do not copy 4 or more words in a row from the speeches or the fact sheet. Restate your claim: name the site or the skate park. Ask the council to act: please, urge, vote, or approve. Give a short reason with because, since, or for these reasons. Original: “First, kids need a safe place to skate. Last Saturday, my brother Niko and I counted 14 skaters in the grocery store parking lot on our street, weaving between cars. A skate park would get them out of traffic. Second, skating is good …” (the full passage is on screen; it is long, so only its opening is shown here)	**Sample:** For these reasons, I respectfully ask you to vote for a skate park at Site 1, since it lets neighborhood kids skate safely without riding a long way.	A strong closing restates the claim, gives a short reason, and politely asks the council to act, with no bandwagon, overgeneralization, or insults, in new words. Auto-check rubric: at least 16 words; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original (names count as one word); must include: site 1 or site 2 or skate park; please or urge or ask or request or vote or approve or choose or consider or pick; because or since or for these reasons or so that or therefore or reason.

MATCH-UP ROUND (2 POINTS PER FIRST-TRY MATCH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
match_s0_1	Set 1: Match claim	**the main opinion a writer argues**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_2	Set 1: Match reason	**why the writer believes the claim**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_3	Set 1: Match evidence	**facts that prove a reason**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_4	Set 1: Match counterargument	**the other side’s point**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_5	Set 1: Match rebuttal	**an answer to the other side**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_1	Set 2: Match bandwagon	**“Everybody wants it, so vote yes.”**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_2	Set 2: Match overgeneralization	**“Skaters never clean up.”**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_3	Set 2: Match attacking the person	**“Only grumpy people vote no.”**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_4	Set 2: Match relevant evidence	**facts that connect to the reason**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_5	Set 2: Match compromise	**each side gives up a little**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_1	Set 3: Match however	**shows a contrast**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_2	Set 3: Match as a result	**shows an effect**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_3	Set 3: Match furthermore	**adds another point**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_4	Set 3: Match for example	**introduces evidence**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_5	Set 3: Match in conclusion	**begins the ending**	2 points if matched on the first try.

BOSS CHALLENGE (8 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
b1_s0	Set 1: Two-step: Step 1, which of Nizhoni's reasons has the STRONGEST evidence? Step 2, why? [Safety: she counted 14 skaters weaving between cars, a real observation that connects to her reason. / Exercise: the survey proves kids want Site 1. / Her closing: everybody she knows wants the park. / Noise: she measured how loud skateboards are.]	**Safety: she counted 14 skaters weaving between cars, a real observation that connects to her reason.**	Her count is real, relevant evidence for the safety reason (though one day is a small sample). The survey does not ask about sites, the closing is a bandwagon trap, and she never measured noise.
b2_s0	Set 1: Two-step: Step 1, what do the two speakers mainly DISAGREE about? Step 2, which evidence shows it? [Where to build the park, not whether to build one: Mr. Nolan says, "I support giving kids a place to skate." / Whether to build any park: Mr. Nolan says skate parks should be banned. / How much the park costs: Nizhoni says it is too expensive. / What time it closes: Mr. Nolan wants it open until midnight.]	**Where to build the park, not whether to build one: Mr. Nolan says, "I support giving kids a place to skate."**	Both want a skate park. Their disagreement is Site 1 versus Site 2. The other choices state things neither speaker said.
b1_s1	Set 2: Which COMPROMISE answers the biggest worries from BOTH speakers? [Pick either site but fix its weak spot (a crosswalk at Site 1 or a bus stop at Site 2), and keep the no-lights, close-at-sunset plan. / Build at Site 1 and add bright lights so kids can skate until midnight. / Cancel the skate park because the speakers disagree. / Build at Site 2 and tell east-side kids to find their own way there.]	**Pick either site but fix its weak spot (a crosswalk at Site 1 or a bus stop at Site 2), and keep the no-lights, close-at-sunset plan.**	A compromise gives each side something. Fixing the crosswalk or bus stop answers the safety and access worries, and the sunset plan answers the noise and dark-sky worries. The other choices ignore one or both speakers.
b2_s1	Set 2: Two-step: Nisha is writing FOR Site 1. Step 1, which counterargument should she answer? Step 2, which rebuttal is strongest? [Counterargument: kids would cross a busy road with no crosswalk. Rebuttal: ask the city to add a crosswalk, since Site 1 already has a bus stop. / Counterargument: Site 2 has no bus stop. Rebuttal: buses are always late. / Counterargument: kids would cross a busy road. Rebuttal: everyone at my school wants Site 1. / Counterargument: skaters never clean up. Rebuttal: Mr. Nolan is just grumpy.]	**Counterargument: kids would cross a busy road with no crosswalk. Rebuttal: ask the city to add a crosswalk, since Site 1 already has a bus stop.**	The crosswalk is the other side's strongest point against Site 1, and a crosswalk would solve it. The other rebuttals use an overgeneralization, a bandwagon, or an insult.
b1_s2	Set 3: Two-step: Noelle is writing FOR Site 2. Step 1, which counterargument should she answer? Step 2, which rebuttal is strongest? [Counterargument: Site 2 is 1.5 miles from the east side with no bus stop yet. Rebuttal: ask the city to add a bus stop, and point out Site 2 already has sidewalks and parking. / Counterargument: Site 1 is closer. Rebuttal: kids who live close are lazy. / Counterargument: Site 2 is far away. Rebuttal: everybody prefers Site 2. / Counterargument: Site 2 has sidewalks. Rebuttal: sidewalks are dangerous.]	**Counterargument: Site 2 is 1.5 miles from the east side with no bus stop yet. Rebuttal: ask the city to add a bus stop, and point out Site 2 already has sidewalks and parking.**	The distance and missing bus stop are the strongest points against Site 2, and a bus stop would answer them. The other rebuttals attack people, jump on the bandwagon, or misstate the facts.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
b2_s2	Set 3: Which revision of Nizhoni's closing makes her point WITHOUT a reasoning trap? ["For these reasons, safety and exercise, I urge you to vote yes on Site 1." / "Everyone at my school wants it, so vote yes." / "Anyone who votes no does not care about kids." / "Skate parks always make towns happier."]	**"For these reasons, safety and exercise, I urge you to vote yes on Site 1."**	The correct revision restates her reasons and asks politely. The others use bandwagon, attacking the person, and overgeneralization.

Pre & Post sheet answer guide

Many items are open-ended. Grade for genuine understanding and complete sentences, not exact wording. Sheet: grade4-5/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G4-5W29.pdf.

PRE-LESSON WARM-UP

#	Prompt	Model answer / grading note
1	Review: a lake "about 40 feet deep" (Source A) and "nearly 50 feet deep" (Source B)	Model: The lake is about 40 to 50 feet deep (Sources A and B).
2	A time you tried to convince someone	Answers vary. Check for what the student wanted and one reason.
3	Which sentence is a claim someone could argue about?	Our town should build a skate park.
4	"Everybody in my class wants a later bedtime, so you should say yes."	Not a strong reason. It is a bandwagon argument: many people wanting something does not prove it is a good idea.
5	Why explain the OTHER side first?	Model: It shows the writer is fair, helps readers trust the writer, and lets the writer answer the strongest objection with a rebuttal.

POST-LESSON CHALLENGE

#	Prompt	Model answer / grading note
1	One strong piece of evidence from each speaker; which argument is better supported?	Answers vary. Nizhoni: she counted 14 skaters weaving between cars in a parking lot. Mr. Nolan: the fact sheet shows homes are 150 feet from Site 1 but 500 feet from Site 2 (or the busy road with no crosswalk). Accept either site when the reason is tied to evidence.
2	Nikhil: "Skate parks always cause trouble, so no town should ever build one."	Overgeneralization (always, no town, ever). Model fair version: Some neighbors worry that a skate park could bring noise or trash, so the town should plan rules and trash cans before it builds one.
3	Why 248 of 400 cannot tell the council WHICH site to choose	Model: The survey asked only whether people support building a skate park. It did not ask which site they prefer, so those 248 people could favor either site.
4	Be the editor	a) Dear Council Members, b) However, the park could have opened sooner.

★ CHALLENGE

#	Prompt	Model answer / grading note
1	Three sentences to the City Council: claim, reason, rebuttal	Answers vary. Grading note: a clear claim for Site 1 or Site 2, one reason backed by a fact from the lesson, and a rebuttal that states the other side fairly before answering it (for example, with However,), with no reasoning traps.